LECTURE 2

THE INFORMATION CYCLE AND TECHNOLOGY

GBX0009

INFORMATION SEEKING, WRITING & ACADEMIC PUBLICATIONS

User Education Section, UM Library

INFORMATION CYCLE

What?

- **Progression of media coverage** relating to a particular **event** or **topic**
- The way information is **produced** and **distributed**
- How **information changes over time** - Different types of sources appear at different times after an event (e.g., news reports, journal articles, books).

Why?

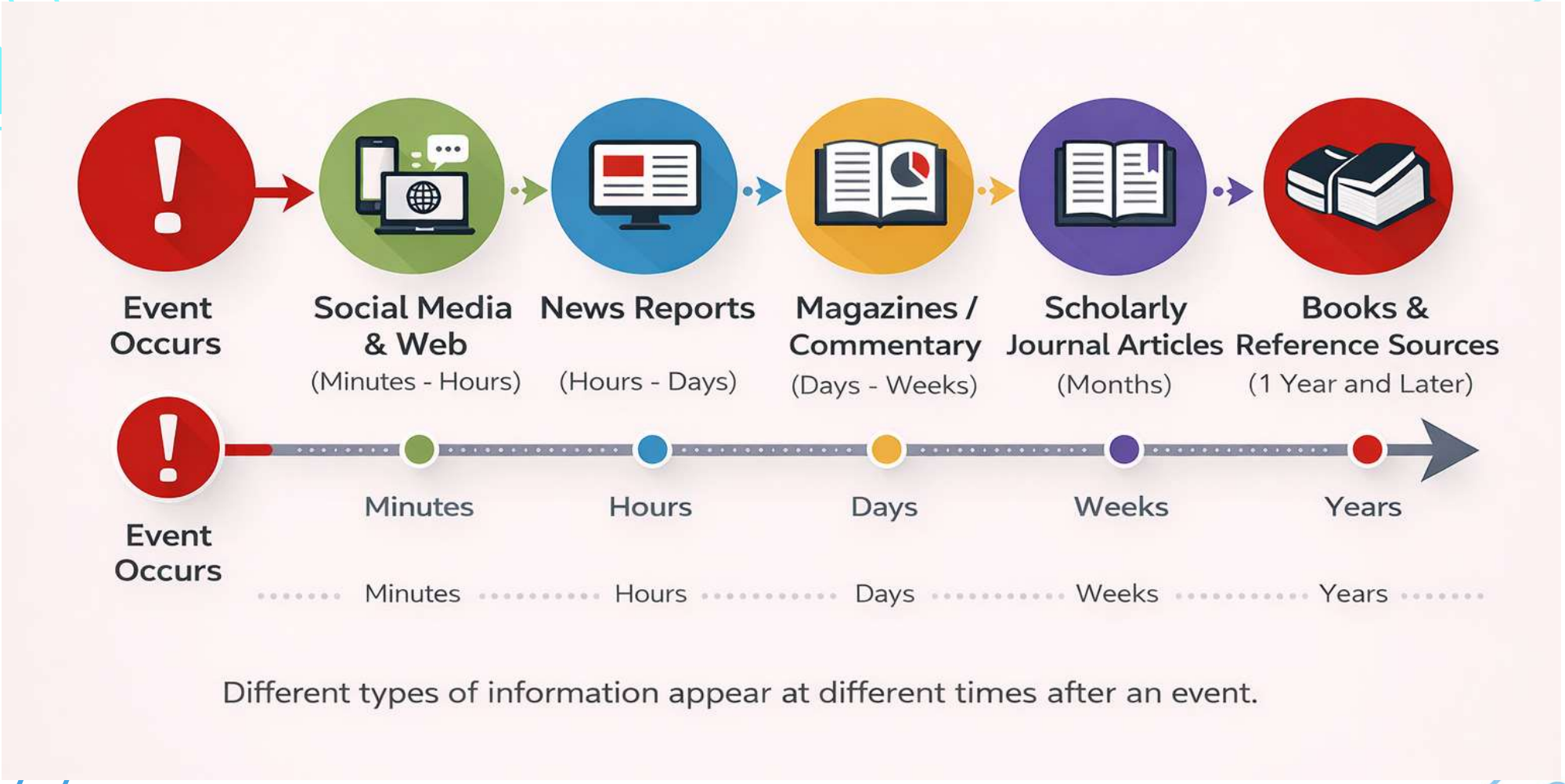
Understanding how the information cycle works:

- Helps researchers **identify** the most **appropriate sources** for their information needs.
- **Explains** why some information appears earlier than others.
- Supports **critical evaluation** of sources and understanding of information development over time.

How?

Typical progression of information after an event:

- **Immediate information** - social media posts, breaking news
- **News reports** - newspapers, online news portals
- **Commentary and analysis** - magazines, opinion pieces
- **Scholarly research** - journal articles
- **Comprehensive sources** – books and reference materials



Different types of information appear at different times after an event.



THE EVENT

Live / Day of

- TV/Radio
- Internet
- Social media

Up-to-the-minute information and breaking news stories, frequent updates, quick, short, not very detailed

Week of

- Newspaper
- News media

More detailed information (i.e., more facts) and a deeper investigation into the immediate context

Weeks after

- Magazines
- Government information (Speeches, Press release)

More detailed, provide analysis and discuss the impact the event has

Months after

- Scholarly resources: Journals, Conference paper

Comprehensive analysis, empirical research reports, and learned commentary, theoretical impact analysis

Year after

- Reference works: Books, Government Reports

In-depth, comprehensive coverage of an event, expanding upon themes, subjects, and analysis

More reading:
https://libguides.tru.ca/c.php?g=193994&p=1275903

DISCUSSION ACTIVITY

Advancements in communication technology allow news and information to spread faster and in greater detail than ever before. What are the positive and negative impacts of rapid information access and dissemination from two perspectives?

1. Humans
2. The information